

SA05 MANAGE MOLD AND MOISTURE | O (MAX: 1 PT)

Intent: Limit the potential for bacteria and mold growth within buildings from water infiltration, condensation and internal leaks.

Summary: This feature requires projects to manage mold and moisture through inspections.

Issue: Excess moisture and dampness is a common problem in buildings, affecting about 20% of buildings in Europe, Canada and the U.S.²³⁵ When improperly managed, moisture creates conditions conducive to the growth of mold and other biological pests, which can increase the risk of developing respiratory infections and asthma for those within the building.²³⁵ It is estimated that one fifth of asthma cases in the U.S. are caused by excess moisture and dampness in buildings.²³⁶ Furthermore, moisture can damage the building itself by creating an environment hospitable to insects and other destructive pests, corroding metal components and degrading wood and porous building materials.²³⁷ These problems can arise when water unintentionally penetrates the building envelope or leaks from indoor uses of water, or when moisture-heavy air condenses on building materials.

Solutions: Inspections are needed to both verify that design and operations properly safeguards against mold growth, as well as informs the need for preventative maintenance.²³⁸

Part 1 Part 1 (Max: 1 Pt)

For All Spaces:

The project implements a moisture management plan for building operations that contains the following:

- a. A system for occupants and tenants to notify building management about mold or water damage.
- b. A schedule of periodic inspections for signs and potential sources of water damage or pooling, discoloration and mold on ceilings, walls, floors and HVAC equipment.
- c. A system or inspection protocol to periodically assess water pipe leaks.

The following requirement is met:

- a. Results of inspections for mold and leaks (including any mold test results) are submitted annually through the WELL digital platform.